

Emilio Barkett

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| EDUCATION           | <div><div>Columbia University2024 – 2025</div><div>M.A. in Media Studies &amp; Sociology<br/>Advisors: Diane Vaughan, James Chu, David M. Markowitz<br/>Thesis: <i>Status Hierarchies in Language Models</i></div><div>Brigham Young University–Hawaii2022 – 2024</div><div>B.A. in Communication; Minor in Political Science<br/>Research Advisor: Mason Allred</div></div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| AREAS OF INTEREST   | AI Behavior; Science of Personas; Human-AI Interaction; Organizational Risk                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| RESEARCH EXPERIENCE | <div><div><div>Supervised Program for Alignment ResearchBerkeley, CA (<i>Remote</i>)<br/>Research MentorDec 2025 – Present</div><div>Columbia AI Alignment ClubNew York, NY<br/>Research Manager / Fellowship FacilitatorJan 2025 – Dec 2025</div><div>Columbia Business SchoolNew York, NY<br/>Research InternJune 2025 – Aug 2025<br/>Research Advisor: Alan Zhang</div><div>Columbia UniversityNew York, NY<br/>Research AssistantJan 2025 – July 2025<br/>Research Advisor: James Chu</div></div></div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| BOOK                | <div><div>[1] Outstanding Stories from Kiribati.<br/>Emilio Barkett<br/>Barnes and Noble Press, 2022. <a href="#">[link]</a></div></div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| PUBLICATIONS        | <div><div>[9] Normalization of Deviance in AI Development.†<br/>Emilio Barkett, Alexander Kimpton, Daniel Graham, Yusuf Kundgol<br/><i>NeurIPS 2026 AI4Good Workshop</i>. (under review). <a href="#">[arXiv]</a>.</div><div>[8] Social Pressure Induces Moral Sycophancy in Frontier LLMs.†<br/>Roshni Lulla*, Kristin Witte*, Saloni Modi*, Emilio Barkett*<br/><i>Working Paper</i>.</div><div>[7] Whose Alignment? Process Alignment Across Organizational Contexts.†<br/>Niklas Weller*, Emilio Barkett*<br/><i>ICML 2026 Workshop on Pluralistic Alignment</i>. <a href="#">[arXiv]</a>.</div><div>[6] Representation Without Control: Testing the Realization Effect in Language Models.†<br/>Ciaran Walsh, Emilio Barkett<br/><i>NeurIPS 2026 SocialAgent Workshop</i>. (under review). <a href="#">[arXiv]</a>.</div><div>[5] The Compulsory Imaginary: AGI and Corporate Authority.<br/>Emilio Barkett<br/><i>Preprint</i>, 2026. <a href="#">[arXiv]</a></div><div>[4] Status Hierarchies in Language Models.<br/>Emilio Barkett<br/><i>Master’s Thesis</i>, 2026. <a href="#">[arXiv]</a>.</div><div>[3] Getting out of the Big-Muddy: Escalation of Commitment in LLMs.<br/>Emilio Barkett*, Olivia Long*, Paul Kröger<br/><i>NeurIPS 2026 SocialAgent Workshop</i>. (under review). <a href="#">[arXiv]</a>.</div><div>[2] Don’t Change My View: Ideological Bias Auditing in Large Language Models.<br/>Paul Kröger, Emilio Barkett<br/><i>NeurIPS 2026 SocialAgent Workshop</i>. (under review). <a href="#">[arXiv]</a>.</div></div> |

- [1] Reasoning Isn't Enough: Examining Truth-Bias and Sycophancy in LLMs.  
**Emilio Barkett\***, Olivia Long\*, Madhavendra Thakur\*  
*ICML 2025 Workshop on Models of Human Feedback for AI Alignment. [arXiv].*

\* Denotes equal contribution.

† Denotes projects mentored through SPAR.

## WORKS IN PROGRESS

- [5] Organizational Drift in Frontier AI Development: Evidence from Policy Revisions, Personnel Testimony, and National Strategies.†  
**Emilio Barkett**, Alexander Kimpton, Daniel Graham, Yusuf Kundgol  
*Working Paper.*
- [4] Algorithmic Appreciation in Language Models.†  
Maya De Ganyar, **Emilio Barkett**  
*Working Paper.*
- [3] Agent Swarm Dynamics.†  
William Neild, **Emilio Barkett**  
*Working Paper.*
- [2] Deception in Language Models.†  
Hannah Sun, **Emilio Barkett**  
*Working Paper.*
- [1] Economics of Token Output.†  
Peiyu Chen, **Emilio Barkett**  
*Working Paper.*

## AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS

|                                                                  |                      |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|
| BlueDot Rapid Grant, \$3,000.                                    | Sept 2026            |
| Supervised Program for Alignment Research, \$5,250.              | Dec 2025 – Present   |
| Claude Campus Ambassador, Anthropic, \$1,750.                    | Aug 2025 – Dec 2025  |
| AI Policy Fellowship, Columbia AI Alignment Club.                | Jan 2025 – June 2025 |
| Service Scholarship, Brigham Young University–Hawaii, \$1,500.   | 2022                 |
| Dean's List Scholarship, Brigham Young University–Hawaii, \$500. | 2022                 |

## PRESENTATIONS

### Conferences

- ICML 2026 Workshop, Seoul, South Korea, July 2026. *Whose Alignment? Process Alignment Across Organizational Contexts*
- Beyond Our Screens: Reimagining Critical Media Literacy Symposium, University of Notre Dame, August 2025. *The Compulsory Imaginary: AGI and Corporate Authority*
- ICML 2025 Workshop, Vancouver, Canada, July 2025. *Reasoning Isn't Enough: Examining Truth-Bias and Sycophancy in LLMs*
- Cultural Studies Association 2025 Conference, California Institute of the Arts, May 2025. *Sociotechnical Imaginaries in AGI Development*
- Data Science Day, Columbia University, April 2025. *The Compulsory Imaginary: AGI and Corporate Authority*
- AI Summit, Columbia University, March 2025. *The Compulsory Imaginary: AGI and Corporate Authority*
- Artifacts of Control, Lincoln Center for the Performing Arts, Dec 2024. *Surveillance on Campus*
- Undergraduate Research Conference, Brigham Young University–Hawaii, Dec 2024. *Media and War: A Genealogy of the Alternate Narrative*

## MENTORING

### Research Mentoring

- Peiyu Chen (2026), University of Chicago Booth School of Business.
- Maya De Ganyar (2026), UC Berkeley.
- Hannah Sun (2026), University of Washington.
- William Neild (2026), Emory.
- Alexander Kimpton (2026), Dragoman. Published. [9].
- Yusuf Kundgol (2026), Oxford. Published. [9].

- Daniel Graham (2026), State Street. Published. [9].
- Shruti Das (2026), Columbia University Masters. Former Apple.
- Weian Xie (2026), MIT.
- Saloni Modi (2026), Bloomberg. Former UT Austin. Published. [8].
- Hayzie Chu (2026), Brown University Undergrad.
- Niklas Weller (2026), University of St. Gallen PhD. Published. [7].
- Raghav Pant (2026), JPMorganChase. Former Brown University.
- Dan Sachs (2026), Independent Researcher. Former Georgetown University.
- Ciáran Walsh (2026), Columbia University Undergrad. Published. [6].
- Madhavendra Thakur (2025), Independent Researcher. Published. [1]. Now at Harvard; YC Fellow.
- Olivia Long (2025), Columbia University Undergrad. Published. [1, 3]. Former XLab.

## ACADEMIC SERVICE

### **Program Committee Member**

- Workshops: AI for Social Impact (AAAI 2026, 2027)

### **Reviewer**

- Conferences: NeurIPS (2025, 2026), IASEAI (2026)
- Workshops: SocialAgent (NeurIPS 2026), Interpretability as a Science (NeurIPS 2026), AI4GOOD (NeurIPS 2026), Pluralistic Alignment (ICML 2026), Models of Human Feedback for AI Alignment (ICML 2025), Socially Responsible Language Modeling Research (COLM 2025)

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

### **Languages & Tools:**

Python, R, HTML, Git, L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X, Figma, Qualtrics, Amazon MTurk, Prolific Academic, OSF, arXiv

### **Human Languages:**

English (native), Gilbertese (advanced), American Sign Language (basic)